

The Apollo Moon Landings

The Apollo program was the NASA manned spaceflight project that landed humans on the Moon between 1969 and 1972. It was announced by President John F. Kennedy in a speech to Congress on 25 May 1961 and achieved its goal when Apollo 11 landed on 20 July 1969.

Apollo 11's crew consisted of Neil Armstrong (commander), Buzz Aldrin (lunar module pilot), and Michael Collins (command module pilot). Armstrong and Aldrin landed the Lunar Module Eagle in the Sea of Tranquility at 20:17 UTC. Armstrong stepped onto the surface at 02:56 UTC on 21 July, declaring "that's one small step for [a] man, one giant leap for mankind".

The Saturn V rocket, designed by Wernher von Braun's team at the Marshall Space Flight Center in Huntsville, Alabama, launched every Apollo mission. The Saturn V stood 110 metres tall and produced 34 meganewtons of thrust at liftoff.

Six missions landed on the Moon: Apollo 11, 12, 14, 15, 16, and 17. Apollo 13 was a failed landing that became a successful rescue. Twelve men walked on the Moon; Eugene Cernan of Apollo 17, in December 1972, was the last.